Bukhārā. Before commencing his march, he had solemnly vowed that if successful, he would henceforth rigorously adhere to Musalmān Law. This vow was taken in Ḥaẓrat Turkistān at the shrine of Khwāja Aḥmad Yasawī, a saint revered in Central Asia for many centuries. He passed away around AD 1120. Tīmūr had undertaken a pilgrimage to his tomb in AD 1397, and subsequently, he founded the mosque that still dominates the town, serving as a landmark for pilgrims to this day. 'Ubaid's vow, similar to Babur's in the AD 1526, represented a commitment to return to obedience. Both men made their oaths with the fervour of Ghāzīs, but with different targets in mind. Babur's oath was directed against the Hindus, whom he regarded as heathens, while 'Ubaid's oath was aimed at Babur, whom he saw as a heretic.

b) Bābur's defeat at Kul-i-malik

In Ṣafar (April–May of AD of 1512) 'Ubaid swiftly advanced and attacked the Bukhārā vicinity. Babur travelled from Samarkand to confront him. Several details of the ensuing events are not mentioned by Ḥaidar, and in one specific instance, it is mentioned by Khwānd-amīr but with contradiction to former. The point of contention between the two historians is Ḥaidar's claim that 'Ubaid had only 3000 men while Babur had 40,000. Analysing various factors one is safe to lend credibility to Khwānd-amīr's contrary assertion that Babur's force was relatively small. It's worth noting that Ḥaidar did not participate in this campaign; he was unwell in Samarkand and remained there for some time. Khwānd-amīr's details have the air of being well-informed, potentially acquired firsthand, perhaps from someone in Hindustan after AD 1527.

Several factors that weigh against the notion of Babur commanding a large, effective force at Kul-i-malik and favour Khwānd-amīr's account of the affair are as below:

1. 'Ubaid must have assessed the opposition he would face and brought 3,000
difficult to fathom where Babur could have mustered 40,000 men who were
of fighting. In various times of crisis, Babur's immediate and consistently lo
is reported to be only 500.
2. As his cause was currently unpopular, there might have been few local addit
his force. Some Moghūls from Merv and Kābul were in the vicinity of Sama
and most were with Sa'īd in Andijān.[*]
3. However, regardless of how many Moghūls were in the vicinity, none could
counted on to steadfastly support Babur's success. Moreover, if he had poss
significant effective force, wouldn't he have attempted to hold Samarkand w
remnants of his defeated army until Persian assistance arrived?